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DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION

Learning Activity Sheet for English

Quarter 4
Lesson
2

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Learning Activity Sheet for English Grade 8
Quarter 4: Lesson 2 (Week 2)
SY 2025-2026

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LEARNING ACTIVITY SHEET

Learning Area:	English 8	**Quarter:**	4th
Lesson No.:	2 (of 2)	**Date:**	
Lesson Title/ Topic:	**Getting to Know a Formal Letter of Inquiry vs. Other Letters**		
Name:		**Grade & Section:**	

I. Activity No.1: Word Association (5 minutes)

II. Objective(s):

A. Recall what letters are.

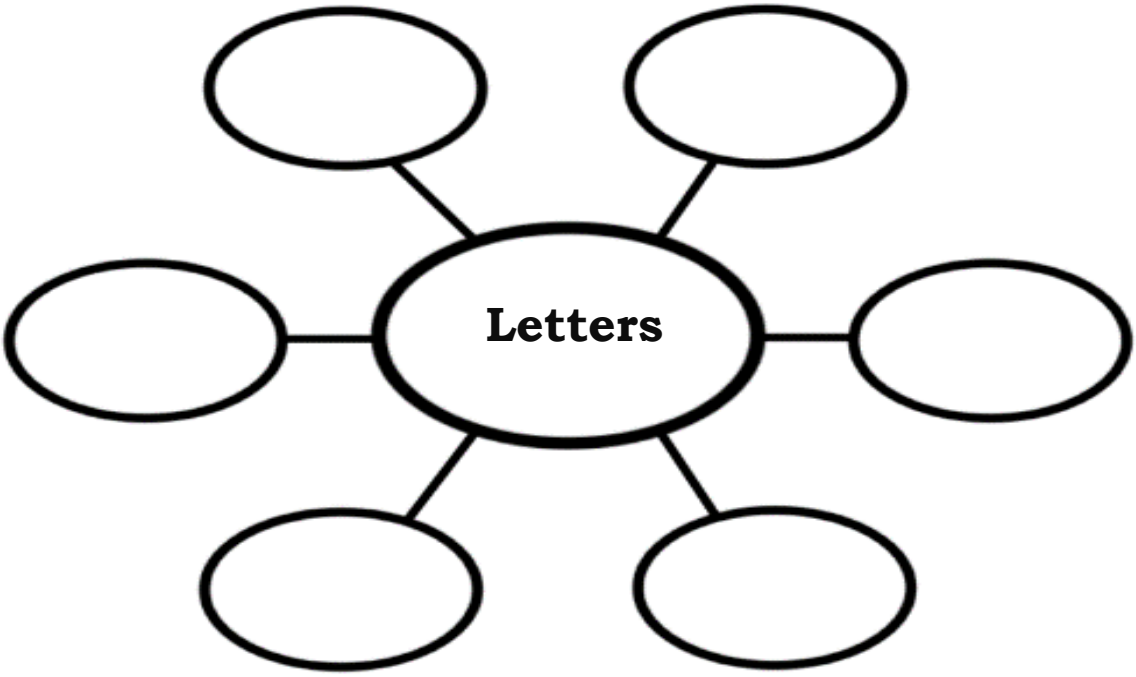
III. Materials Needed:

None

IV. Instructions:

A. Word Association (5 minutes)

Based on their recollection of the previous lesson, students should provide words they associate with the term "letters." Write these associated words into the circles below.



LEARNING ACTIVITY SHEET

Learning Area:	English 8	**Quarter:**	4th Quarter
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I. Activity No.2: Unlocking Content Vocabulary (10-15 minutes)

II. Objective(s):

A. Define key terms useful in understanding a literary text to be read.

III. Materials Needed:

Pen/pencil and paper

IV. Instructions:

Fill in the blanks based on the inputs provided by the teacher. The inputs may either be presented visually or orally.

A. Play—also known as _____, it is a genre of literature that tells a _____ through characters' _____/ lines and _____ performed before an _____ (Balinas, et al., 2005).

B. Modals—are a type of _____ verbs that appear with main or _____ verbs to signify certain _____ (Grammarly, 2023)

C. Khanga—a _____ worn by a woman in _____ Africa

D. Eec, bakanuba—a _____ slang term of respect meaning, "Hey, _____."

E. Numberi—refers to a _____ figure or simply a number

F. Kikapu—a _____ for carrying things

V. Extended Practice:

Based on the meanings you completed above, look for your own actual examples or equivalents in other languages of the terms or expressions that were presented or taught to you. Provide pictures of your examples or write the equivalent words/ expressions here and be ready to share with the class and justify.

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Lesson Title/ Topic:	**Getting to Know a Formal Letter of Inquiry vs. Other Letters**		
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I. Activity No.3: During (25-30 minutes) and After (25-30 minutes) Reading of a Literary Text

II. Objective(s):

A. Demonstrate literal and symbolic understanding of a literary text read.

III. Materials Needed:

Copy of Bones by Sadru Kassam (from Balinas et al., 2005)

IV. Instructions

A. During Reading (25-30 minutes)

While reading, jot down answers to these questions for review later:

a. Who was the author?
b. Where was the author from?
c. What was the author's area of study and profession?
d. What roles did the following characters play in the story?
   - Butcher
   - Kanubhai
   - Dongo
   - Woman and Girl

Play

Bones by Sadru Kassam (from Balinas et al., 2005)

ABOUT THE AUTHOR:

Sadru Kassam was bom in Mombasa, the second largest city in Kenya. He worked as a high school teacher. He became involved with the Free Traveling Theatre while studying English at the Makarere University in Uganda. The theatre group was composed of professors and students who organized to bring the theatre to rural villages and towns.

SCENE: A butcher's shop. A sign reads: "SALEH BIN AWADH, The Big Butcher, P. O. MAJI MOTO, Coast Region. " On one wall is a painting of a bull, and on another a picture of the BUTCHER slaughtering another bull. There are notices reading: "FRESH MEAT" and "WELCOME."

NOTE: It is intended that each scene shall open with an extended mime by the Butcher, which can be developed from the outlines in the stage directions.

SCENE 1

The shop is tolerably clean and tidy. The BUTCHER wears an almost white coat and his hair is combed. He sings as he arranges his meat to conceal its shortcomings. A joint tumbles to the ground: he looks to see if anyone is around, then picks it up and brushes it before replacing it, clean side upwards. He spits and scratches himself vigorously. He starts dividing some meat into smaller sections with a large knife, swinging the blade dangerously. At length he cuts himself, shrieks, prances around, tends his bleeding finger, wipes the blood off on a piece of meat and sucks the wound. The WOMAN is heard singing as she approaches. She enters, wearing a khanga.

[1]**WOMAN:** Eec, banakuba? How are you?

[2]**BUTCHER:** Me? Very well, mama, very well. You want meat?

[3]**WOMAN:** Yes, banakuba, I want meat. How's your meat? Is it good?

[4]**BUTCHER:** Very good, mama. Good and fresh. Can't you see me in the picture there slaughtering a bull?

[5]**WOMAN:** From what part will you give me?

[6]**BUTCHER:** Any part you want, mama. Whatever you ask for, I'm here to serve you. (He sharpens his knife on his file).

[7]**WOMAN:** I want of that. I hope it's fresh.

[8]**BUTCHER:** Completely fresh, mama: number one. How much do you want?

[9]**WOMAN:** Aaaah! A shilling's worth only — unless you want to give me more on credit.

[10]**BUTCHER:** No, no, no, not today. (The BUTCHER cuts a small piece from the meat the WOMAN has chosen, and then begins to cut larger pieces from another joint.)

[11]**WOMAN:** A-a-a-a, I want off that only.

[12]**BUTCHER:** Yes, but you want good and fresh meat, isn't it? This is very good. See…excellent! Numberi one! I tell you.

[13]**WOMAN:** (Violently) I don't want it.

[14]**BUTCHER:** O.K. your wish. Was it this one you wanted?

[15]**WOMAN:** That’s it. Now you know it.

[16]**BUTCHER:** (He puts some meat on the scale and is about to add several bones).

[17]**WOMAN:** What's that you're doing there? I didn't ask for stones. I don't want them. Remove them at once.

[18]**BUTCHER:** Mama, they aren't stones. They are very good bones with plenty of meat on them. See… excellent! Grade one!

[19]**WOMAN:** And what am I to do with bones? I'm not a dog.

[20]**BUTCHER:** (He finishes weighing the meat and wraps it. The WOMAN takes out a small pouch and offers money which she draws back as the BUTCHER tries to snatch it, so that he pitches across his counter before she gives it to him).

[21]**BUTCHER:** Here it is, mama, your meat.

[22]**WOMAN:** And here's your money... unless you don't want it.

[23]**BUTCHER:** Eh, why not? Thank you, mama, thank you very much. God help you.

[24]**WOMAN:** O.K., banakuba, good-bye.

(A GIRL enters, dressed in a dirty, tattered frock and carrying a kikapu.)

[25]**GIRL:** Get me half a pound of meat, please. Nice — like you!

(As the WOMAN is going out she bumps into DONGO as he enters.)

[26]**DONGO:** Good moming, mama.

[27]**WOMAN:** Good morning, brother.

[28]**DONGO:** What's the quarrel with the butcher?

[29]**WOMAN:** Aaaa, nothing.

[30]**DONGO:** Weren't you complaining of ill treatment? I heard you shouting.

[31]**WOMAN:** No, no, no. I was just joking with him. That butcher is a very nice man, you know.

[32]**DONGO:** I see. O.K. Good-bye.

[34]**GIRL:** Good-bye. (Exit.)

[35]**GIRL:** Give me very good meat, and no bones, please.

[36]**BUTCHER:** No, no, no. No bones. Just a little one for your father.

[37]**GIRL:** No. My father has no teeth.

[38]**BUTCHER:** Oh, I see. (DONGO has been clearing his throat loudly to attract the BUTCHER's attention.) DONGO, Mr. Dongo! Just come over here, please. I'm delighted to see you. How are you?

[39]**DONGO:** Excellent, thank you. And you?

[40]**BUTCHER:** Aaaa, not well at all, because you know you still haven't endorsed my trading license. Please do it just now. Only a week is left before the closing date.

(DONGO stands as if ready to receive a gift. He looks away, pauses, then looks back at his hand as if surprised to see it empty).

[41]**DONGO:** Your trading license? Hasn't anyone taught you how to get it? (The BUTCHER shakes his head).

Just look at your shop! (DONGO sweeps a pile of scraps from the counter onto the floor).

See, the whole floor is littered with scraps and bones. When did you last sweep it? (DONGO wipes his hands, now covered in blood from the meat, on the BUTCHER'S apron).

And why is your apron so dirty? Where is your file? (DONGO takes the file and breaks it in two.)

Why is it broken? (He runs his hands through the BUTCHER'S hair, ruffing it.)

And why have you not combed your hair? Who made you big butcher? Look, you must get things in order before pestering me to endorse your license. Do you understand that?

42**BUTCHER:** I... I'm sorry. I didn't know about these things. If... if you return next week, I promise everything will be in order. But please, I must have the license endorsed by next Monday.

43**DONGO:** That's your business. I'm warning you, if everything is not ready by next week, I won't get your license, is that clear?

44**BUTCHER:** Yes, yes. Everything will be in order next week. I promise.

45**DONGO:** Your business. (Exit).

46**GIRL:** Come on, where's my meat?

47**BUTCHER:** Oh, dear yes. I'm sorry. I won't be a minute. Here it is. (She exits. The BUTCHER surveys his shop in despair).

What's to be done? And that girl she didn't pay me. Which way did she go? Too late! She's made off.

(Enters KANUBHAI, a Hindu trader in dhoti and cap. He holds his nose in disgust as he passes the BUTCHER's shop).

Kanubhai! Oh, Kanubhai! Just come over here please, quick.

48**KANUBHAI:** Come near your stinking meat? No, no, no, never!

49**BUTCHER:** Ah, this old man! (He comes from his shop and crosses to KANUBHAI). Kanubhai, please help me. You know that health inspector. He's refusing to endorse my trading license. I whitewashed my shop and bought a new apron, but still he comes and asks me why my shop's dirty, and why my hair is not stylishly done, and what not. What am I to do?

50**KANUBHAI:** That man! I know him. He's a dog. He's hungry.

51**BUTCHER:** Hungry?

52**KANUBHAI:** Yes, hungry. He wants some bones. (He pretends to snarl).

53**BUTCHER:** Bones?

54**KANUBHAI:** Yes, bones. You still don't understand? (He takes out some coins, jingles them, and pretends to eat them, snarling as he does so.) He wants bones, bones!

55**BUTCHER:** Oh, bones, bones! Yes, I see he wants some bones.

(As the KANUBHAI exits, the BUTCHER leaps joyfully into the air, claps his hands, and returns purposefully to his shop.)

SCENE 2

(The same scene a week later. The floor is littered with rubbish. The BUTCHER's apron is filthy. Rusty knives and broken implements lie around).

ANNOUNCER: The same scene. One week later.

(The BUTCHER stretches, yawns, scratches himself, spits on the floor, kicks at the rubbish. Enters DONGO; he coughs. The BUTCHER works at his counter pretending not to have seen DONGO, who strolls with exaggerated casualness up to the shop. The BUTCHER looks up, pretending surprise).

[56]**BUTCHER:** Oh, Dongo! Good morning. How are you?

[57]**DONGO:** Mmm! Not so well.

[58]**BUTCHER:** Not well? I'm very sorry. Anyway, I hope you've come to endorse my license.

[59]**DONGO:** Endorse your license? Just like that? With such a dirty shop?

[60]**BUTCHER:** Oh, by the way, Mr. Dongo, I almost forgot: I have something for you. I thought you might like a few bones to take home.

(The BUTCHER hands DONGO a small package).

[61]**DONGO:** Bones? Bones? What should I want with bones? (As he fumbles with the package, a couple of coins fall out. He chases after them, and then slips the package in his pocket).

Oh, bones, bones! That's very thoughtful of you. They will come in very handy. (He smiles broadly). Mr. Awadh, your shop looks really clean today. See, no cobwebs, a clean scale, a new broom, a dustbin outside. It's the way we want it. Don't you worry about your hair. Come on, give me those forms. (The BUTCHER hands him the forms. DONGO takes out a pen, goes to sign, but finds the nib is broken). Just lend me your pen, please. Something's gone wrong with mine.

[62]**BUTCHER:** Certainly, certainly. I'm at your service.

(The BUTCHER hands over his pen, which DONGO examines admiringly.)

[63]**DONGO:** Eh, you've bought a new pen. (He finishes signing and slips the pen into his own pocket.) Well that's done. Now you'll be all right. O.K., Mr. Awadh, kwaheri.

[64]**BUTCHER:** Thank you. Kwaheri, kwaheri.

[65]**DONGO:** Kwaheri,

[66]**BUTCHER:** Kwaheri,

(Dongo goes out and then returns for his hat, which he had put on the counter while singing).

[67]**DONGO:** Ah, my hat, there it is. Kwaheri, kwaheri.

[68]**BUTCHER:** Kwaheri. (DONGO goes out. The BUTCHER returns to his work. Enters the WOMAN. She surveys the shop, screws up her face, holds her nose, and walks past with her head in the air).

Hello, mama! Good morning. (She eyes him sourly). Aren't you coming to buy meat today?

[69]**WOMAN:** Just look at your shop! And at yourself! Dirty and stinking! I'm not going to buy meat from you anymore. I'm going to the next butcher, to a cleaner shop. (Exit.)

[70]**BUTCHER:** But mama, mama, I have license. Listen. (He reads). "Certified clean and fit to sell meat for human consumption." Mama! Mama!

End/ Curtain

B. After Reading

Now that you have finished reading the text, read or listen to the reading of the following Latin phrase from the Roman literature scholar Horace. Take note as well of its meaning in the separate sheet you prepared earlier:

"Dulce et utile"

Meaning:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Listen and participate in the discussion of answers to the During Reading questions a to d. Afterwards, answer as well the following additional questions in the separate answer sheet you prepared earlier:

e. Considering that the author served as an English teacher and was involved in theater acting or plays, do you think he may have had a message or messages he wanted readers or viewers of his play to learn? Why or why not? -

_____

_____

_____

_____

f. What message or messages might these be? Are they relatable or applicable to real life?

_____

_____

_____

_____

g. Which scenarios or lines in the play show the message/s you speak of to be relatable or applicable to real life? How and why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

h. Do any of the characters in the story represent real people or groups? Why and how?

_____

_____

_____

i. In other works or in life, such as those in literature, history, or culture, could similar scenarios occur, and could similar characters also appear? How and why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

LEARNING ACTIVITY SHEET

Learning Area:	English 8	**Quarter:**	4th Quarter
Lesson No.:	2 (of 2)	**Date:**	
Lesson Title/ Topic:	**Getting to Know a Formal Letter of Inquiry vs. Other Letters**		
Name:		**Grade & Section:**	

I. Activity No.4: Reading a Formal Letter (15-20 minutes)

II. Objective(s):

A. Familiarize themselves with modals expressing politeness and interrogative sentences.

B. Identify the modals expressing politeness and interrogative sentences used in a text.

III. Materials Needed:

Pen/pencil and paper

IV. Instructions:

Read the letter below, which addresses the same social issue as the literary text you have read. After reading the letter, answer the questions and complete the tasks provided. Write your answers on a separate sheet of paper.

ABC Homes
123 Hope Avenue
Hopeville, USA

April 30, 2024

Engr. Walter Peters
Chief Executive Officer
American Electric Corporation
456 Unity Street
Harmony City, USA

Dear Engr. Peters:

Greetings!

I, Mr. John Smith, the undersigned, write on behalf of the rest of the other home owners of ABC Homes regarding a pressing community concern.
In particular, **may** I know why the American Electric Corporation has been consistently experiencing disruptions in the electricity it provides in Hopeville despite the consistent increase in the fees it charges its consumers? I am genuinely interested in understanding the causes of the disruptions in spite of the fee increase as this situation has been greatly affecting the trust of the consumers in the corporation.

Additionally, **would** it be possible to personally discuss the above between us, the home owners and your good office next week? If the mode requested is not possible, **could** the discussion instead be conducted at least through the virtual mode?
I would be eagerly awaiting your response and **would** make myself available at your convenience for any further discussions or information needed **should** you not be available in the requested time frame.

Warm regards,

John Smith
Home owner

Questions/ Tasks:

a. What are the parts of a formal letter present in the example text? Give the name of the letter part and then read aloud the portion of the example text that corresponds to the letter part you identified.
b. What social problem possibly similar to the one found in Bones is tackled in the example text?
c. What are the requests found in the example text so that the issue may possibly be clarified?
d. What part of speech are the parts of the example text in bold?
e. What type of sentence according to structure are the parts underlined?

LEARNING ACTIVITY SHEET

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Lesson No.:	2 (of 2)	**Date:**	
Lesson Title/ Topic:	**Getting to Know a Formal Letter of Inquiry vs. Other Letters**		
Name:		**Grade & Section:**	

I. Activity No.5: Lesson Activity (25-30 minutes)

II. Objective(s):

A. Familiarize themselves with modals expressing politeness and interrogative sentences.

B. Identify the modals expressing politeness and interrogative sentences used in a text.

III. Materials Needed:

None

IV. Instructions:

On the space before each number, write your answer to each of the following items. Read them carefully.

A. Modal Verbs

1. Identify the TWO modals and TWO action verbs in the following sentence:
Although she was exhausted from the long day at work, Maria decided to attend the evening class because she knew it would enhance her skills and could potentially lead to better job opportunities in the future.

2. Identify the action verb with a modal in the following sentence:
Despite his fear of flying, Mark must travel by plane to attend the important business conference in London next week.

3.Identify the modal of the action verb in the following sentence:
Despite feeling under the weather, Sarah decided to go to the party tonight, as she should make an effort to maintain her social connections.

B. Interrogative Sentences

4. What pattern in interrogative sentence writing is present in the sentence that follows:
Can you swim?

5. What elements from the common pattern used in interrogative sentence writing are NOT present in the following sentence:
Who are you?

6. Try transforming the following sentence into an interrogative one following the pattern HV + SUBJECT + AV + ?:
She does dance.

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Lesson Title/ Topic:	**Getting to Know a Formal Letter of Inquiry vs. Other Letters**		
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I. Activity No.6: Exit Ticket (10-15 minutes)

II. Objective(s):

A. Familiarize themselves with modals expressing politeness and interrogative sentences.

B. Identify the modals expressing politeness and interrogative sentences used in a text.

C. Demonstrate literal and symbolic understanding of a literary text read.

III. Materials Needed:

None

IV. Instructions:

A. Exit Ticket (10-15 minutes)

Complete the following prompts so that the teacher may check if you are already fully prepared to exit this lesson:

1. Modals appear with _____ verbs.
2. Modals are used in suggesting or expressing ideas such as _____.
3. Interrogative sentences are used when _____.
4. In writing interrogative sentences used in inquiry letters, the _____ pattern may be used as a guide.
5. Inquiry letters use interrogative sentences to tackle _____ such as the one found in Bones.